

Michael Schmitt

Manager, Systems Engineering | Solutions Architect | 317-590-3092 |
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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Strategic **Infrastructure Leader with 20+ years of experience** specializing in high-security hybrid-cloud transformations. Expert in architecting **Secure AI environments using Azure AI Foundry**, implementing **Private Link** architectures for zero-trust networking, and driving **CI/CD via GitHub Actions**. Proven track record of managing multi-disciplinary engineering teams to deliver standardized, SOX-compliant enterprise solutions across **Fortinet** and **Azure** ecosystems.

TECHNICAL LEADERSHIP & STACK

- **AI & Cloud Architecture:** Azure AI Foundry (Hubs, Projects, Agents), Azure OpenAI, **Azure Private Link**, Private Endpoints, Bicep/ARM templates.
 - **Leadership:** Direct Management (Multiple FTEs, Multiple Contractors), Vendor/MSP Management, Agile/Sprint Planning, Strategic Roadmapping.
 - **DevOps & Automation:** GitHub Actions (CI/CD), Advanced PowerShell/PowerCLI Module Development, Azure CLI, GitHub CLI.
 - **Secure Networking:** Fortinet Security Fabric (FortiGate, FortiManager, FortiAnalyzer, EMS), SD-WAN, Zero Trust Access.
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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Redwood Trust, Inc. | Englewood, CO **Manager, Systems Engineering** | *December 2021 – Present*

- **Secure AI Infrastructure:** Architected the deployment of **Azure AI Foundry** for enterprise GenAI initiatives. Designed a **Zero-Trust network architecture** utilizing **Azure Private Link** and Private Endpoints to ensure AI workloads remained isolated from the public internet.
- **Governance & Security:** Established AI Hubs and Projects with fine-grained RBAC and Managed Identities, ensuring data privacy and compliance with enterprise risk standards.
- **Team Leadership:** Manage a high-impact team of multiple direct reports and contractors; oversee multiple third-party service providers to maintain 99.99% infrastructure availability.

- **Network Standardization:** Spearheaded the total modernization of the network stack on **Fortinet** (FortiGate, FortiManager, FortiAnalyzer, EMS, FortiSwitches, and FortiAPs), creating a unified security fabric across all corporate sites.
- **CI/CD & Automation:** Migrated legacy deployment workflows to **GitHub Actions**, standardizing infrastructure-as-code (IaC) and reducing environment provisioning time.

Lead Systems Engineer | *January 2019 – December 2021*

- **Architected** end-to-end infrastructure for highly available production environments.
- **Compliance:** Collaborated with Risk and Compliance to design and enforce **SOX controls**, maintaining 100% audit readiness for a decade.
- Managed large-scale Data Center migrations and hardware lifecycle refreshes, significantly reducing OpEx through virtualization and consolidation.

Sr Systems Engineer | *December 2015 - December 2019*

- **Implemented** all flash storage arrays on Pure Storage to reduce shared infrastructure latency to sub-millisecond.
- **Standardized** virtualization, monitoring, and alerting for all infrastructure components.
- **Lead** the migration off of all legacy infrastructure components that were EOL and unsupported.

Progressive Insurance (via Precision Systems) | Colorado Springs, CO **Contract: Systems Engineering Lead** | *July 2015 – December 2015*

- Technical lead for enterprise build activities, including Windows Failover Clustering and complex IIS application delivery.

Troppus Software (An EchoStar Company) | Superior, CO **Lead Systems Engineer/DevOps** | *January 2015 – July 2015*

- **DevOps:** Developed PowerShell release scripts for global dev teams, achieving near-zero downtime deployments.
- **Modern Data:** Implemented NoSQL on RHEL for high-performance data storage.

CNO Financial Group | Carmel, IN | **Sr Systems Engineer** | April 2011 - July 2014

- Implement **VMware** Auto Deploy for rapid provisioning/re-provisioning of new hosts.
- Replace Katello open source project with supported SAM server for Red Hat subscription management and repository management.
- Manage all aspects of 300+ **RHEL** 5.x/6.x VMs. Re-design security model using new version of Samba/Winbind utilizing Kerberos and Active Directory integration.
- Create **bash** and **PowerShell** automation scripts to be included in IT Service Catalog for self service.

- Build and manage **UNIX** AIX 6 environment including redundant HMCs /VIO servers with over 120 LPARS, and multiple HACMP clusters for Oracle database clustering.
- Management of **Active Directory** environment including FSMO role placement, schema updates functionality level updates, DC promotions, etc.
- Manage a large **DFS/DFSR** environment with multiple terabytes of files.
- Manage GPOs for multi-domain multi-forest environments.
- Virtualize over 95% of the datacenter for a multimillion-dollar RIO over 3 years.

EDUCATION

University of Indianapolis, Bachelors of Science, Computer Information Systems

CERTIFICATIONS

- Red Hat Certified Systems Administrator
 - o Certification Number: 140-075-003
 - o Date: 05/02/2014
- Microsoft Certified IT Professional – Enterprise Administrator
 - o MCPID: 6702093
 - o Date: 02/06/2009
- VMware Certified Professional 3,4
 - o Candidate ID: VMW-00112902T-00036930
 - o VCP 3 date: 3/20/2009
 - o VCP 4 date: 08/26/2011